Variables

A variable lets you store a single value in your computer's memory with a descriptive name. Using variables lets you easily refer to the same value many times in your program or save a number that you'd like to refer to later.

Creating Variables

```
var size;
```

The command `var` will create a new variable with the label that you give it. This variable has the label `size`.

Assigning Values

```
size = 100;
```

The assignment operator `=` will assign a new value to your variable. This command assigned 100 to the variable `size`. The variable must always be on the left side. You would read this command as "size gets 100" since size is getting a new value of 100. Any old values it might have been assigned are lost forever.

Using a Value

```
ellipse(200, 200, size, size);
```

In order to use a variable's value, place its label in the spot in your code you want to use it. This command uses the value in `size` to set the width and height of the ellipse.

Initializing

```
var size = 100;
```

Usually you'll want to give a variable its first (or "initial") value right away. You can initialize a variable in a single command by combining the `var` and `=` commands.

After you initialize a variable you don't need to use the `var` command to assign a new value. Just use the `=` as normal.

```
var size = 100;
size = 110;
```

Found a bug in the documentation? Let us know at **documentation@code.org**

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